Pregnancy Timelines

Volume 18 — realistic medical timelines worked backward from the locked birth dates. As doctors do, pregnancy weeks are counted from the first day of the last menstrual period (LMP); conception happens about two weeks later.

1. Esther Smilley: Twins Emma and Victoria (born May 10, 2012)

Twin pregnancies usually deliver early. On average twins arrive at about 36 weeks, versus about 40 for a single baby. The twins are born at **36 weeks, 3 days**: healthy, a little small, with a short precautionary stay in the NICU possible.

Milestone	Date	Story context
Last menstrual period	Mon, Aug 29, 2011	*The Avengers* is wrapping principal photography in New York
Conception (approx.)	~Mon, Sept 12, 2011	Right after the *Avengers* wrap, months after Marc and Esther finally get together in 2011
Positive test (~6 weeks)	~Mon, Oct 10, 2011	Fatigue, nausea, and a secret pharmacy run
First ultrasound: TWINS (~8 weeks)	~Mon, Oct 24, 2011	The doctor sees two heartbeats
End of first trimester (12 weeks)	~Mon, Nov 21, 2011	The usual time to tell family. Twins show earlier than a single baby.
Showing / public announcement (~16 weeks)	~Mon, Dec 19, 2011	Hard to hide at the holidays. A media explosion: unmarried, the Smilley "good girl" brand gone overnight
Anatomy scan (20 weeks)	~Mon, Jan 16, 2012	Two girls
Third trimester / likely bed rest (28 weeks)	~Mon, Mar 12, 2012	Doctors limit travel and long days on her feet
Avengers L.A. premiere	Wed, Apr 11, 2012	She'd be **32 weeks** along with twins. A short appearance at most, with her doctor's permission, or she watches from home.
The Avengers opens	Fri, May 4, 2012	35 weeks, 4 days
Birth	**Thu, May 10, 2012**	36 weeks, 3 days. Emma first; Victoria 25 minutes later. Esther is 29, Marc is 30.
Original due date (40 weeks)	Mon, June 4, 2012	The twins arrive about 3.5 weeks early, which is normal for twins

Production check: *Thor: The Dark World* starts filming in September 2012, when the twins are four months old, so Esther has time to recover and retrain before doing her own stunts. Her pregnancy conflicts with no filming, only with the *Avengers* press tour.

2. Harmony Divine: Lyric Baker (born April 20, 2014)

A single full-term pregnancy. Lyric is born at **39 weeks, 6 days**, one day before her due date.

Milestone	Date	Story context
Amond and Harmony together	2013 (locked)	Early 2013, after she finally stops saying "just friends"
Captain America: The Winter Soldier filming	Apr - June 2013	Black Widow's big role is fully shot **before** the pregnancy

Milestone	Date	Story context
Last menstrual period	Mon, July 15, 2013	
Conception (approx.)	~Mon, July 29, 2013	
Positive test (~5 weeks)	~Mon, Aug 19, 2013	
End of first trimester (12 weeks)	~Mon, Oct 7, 2013	Tell family. Marc is asked to be godfather.
Anatomy scan (20 weeks)	~Mon, Dec 2, 2013	A girl
Avengers: Age of Ultron begins filming	Feb 2014	Harmony is about 30 weeks along
The Winter Soldier premiere	Mar 13, 2014	About 34 weeks, very pregnant on the red carpet
Birth	**Sun, Apr 20, 2014**	Easter Sunday. Harmony is 31, Amond is 32.
Due date (40 weeks)	Mon, Apr 21, 2014	

Production conflict (based on real history): Harmony is heavily pregnant when *Age of Ultron* starts filming in February 2014, the same thing that happened to Scarlett Johansson, who was pregnant during that real shoot. Marvel schedules Black Widow's scenes for the end of the shoot (July-August 2014), three months after Lyric is born. Under the rule that actors do their own stunts, Harmony retrains through the spring, so a few early scenes need careful framing. That makes for good real-world drama: insurance, schedules, and Harmony's determination to do every fight herself.

Marriages for reference: Marc-Anthony and Esther marry in 2013, after the twins. Amond and Harmony marry in 2015, after Lyric. Exact wedding dates are still to be decided.